

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Friday, 26 June 2026 · 21:52 IST

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Bottom line: Competitors are intensifying efforts on AI agent pricing models and deployment speed (Agentforce) while simultaneously highlighting the need for human oversight (Five9) or grappling with negative public perception of basic chatbots (Parloa). This creates an opening for Kore.ai to emphasize its differentiated, governed, and truly agentic platform that delivers reliable, trusted automation and predictable TCO.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Agentforce pushes resolution-based pricing and rapid deployment

WHAT HAPPENED

(2026-06-25) Salesforce launched an Agentforce Help Agent that deploys in minutes and only charges for resolutions, alongside expanding Agentforce into Salesforce Suites and Slack CRM for small businesses in the Philippines (2026-06-26) — [Salesforce](#) and Salesforce. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

This highlights a shift towards outcome-based pricing and rapid deployment, but Agentforce's history of "pricing chaos" and "credit anxiety" (KB) creates an opening for Kore.ai to emphasize its predictable, per-agent/intent/tool cost attribution and ABL's deterministic execution for *reliable*, auditable resolutions, avoiding ambiguity around "what counts as a resolution."

Parloa survey reveals widespread chatbot avoidance

WHAT HAPPENED

(2026-06-25) A Parloa-commissioned survey found that over half of Americans actively avoid chatbots, reflecting ongoing consumer skepticism towards conversational AI — NewsBytes. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

This validates Kore.ai's focus on delivering sophisticated, truly agentic AI with ABL's compile-time validation and deterministic execution to build trust and deliver effective, human-like interactions, directly countering the negative perception associated with basic, frustrating chatbots.

Five9 emphasizes human oversight in AI strategy

WHAT HAPPENED

(2026-06-24) Five9 announced that human oversight is central to its new Voice AI Strategy at CCW, supported by new research showing 92% AI adoption in CX but continued consumer reliance on human support — CX Today and Business Wire. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)

While human oversight is always important, Five9's strong emphasis suggests their AI agents may lack the maturity and determinism for truly autonomous, trusted interactions, exposing their "bolt-on" AI (KB). Kore.ai's ABL-driven agents are designed for high reliability and auditability, reducing the *need* for constant human intervention in routine tasks and building inherent trust.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-06-25) Launches Agentforce Help Agent with resolution-based pricing and rapid deployment — Salesforce	High	Predictable TCO + deterministic ABL vs. opaque consumption
Parloa	(2026-06-25) Survey finds over half of Americans actively avoid chatbots — NewsBytes	Med	Differentiate true agentic AI vs. frustrating chatbots
Five9	(2026-06-24) Human oversight central to Voice AI strategy; consumer trust depends on human support — CX Today	Med	ABL's determinism reduces need for constant human intervention
ServiceNow Agent Platform	(2026-06-26) Adds HCLTech and Google to AI arsenal, expanding AI tie-ups — Ad-hoc-news.de	Low	Kore.ai's model-agnostic tiering offers superior flexibility
Cresta	(2026-06-25) Partners with New York Mets to optimize ticket services with conversational AI — PR Newswire	Low	Kore.ai offers full-lifecycle platform breadth beyond niche use cases
Genesys	(2026-06-24) APAC partners honored as AI CX sees stronger demand — CRN Asia	Low	Kore.ai's AI ARR growth and analyst leadership are stronger proof points
IBM Agent Platform	(2026-06-25) Publishes explanation of AI agent testing — IBM	Low	Kore.ai's ABL offers compile-time validation, superior to post-build testing

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Further details on Agentforce's "resolution-based" pricing model and its true TCO implications for enterprise customers.
- Parloa's response to negative chatbot sentiment and any shifts in their messaging or product strategy.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Arm sales teams with clear messaging on Kore.ai's predictable, per-outcome cost attribution and ABL's deterministic execution to counter Agentforce's new pricing model and "minutes" deployment claims.
- Develop product marketing materials that explicitly differentiate Kore.ai's sophisticated, truly agentic AI from generic "chatbots" to address widespread consumer skepticism highlighted by the Parloa survey.
- Position Kore.ai's ABL as the solution for building inherently trustworthy and reliable AI agents, reducing the need for constant human oversight that competitors like Five9 are emphasizing.
- Engage Analyst Relations to reinforce Kore.ai's Leader position in Conversational AI for CX, contrasting with competitors' less mature or less validated offerings.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- Salesforce Brings Agentforce into Salesforce Suites and Slack CRM for Small Businesses in the Philippines - Salesforce
- Salesforce Launches Agentforce Help Agent That Deploys in Minutes and Only Charges for Resolutions - [Salesforce](#)
- ServiceNow Adds HCLTech and Google to Its AI Arsenal — The Stock Still Can't Catch a Break - [Ad-hoc-news.de](#)
- HCLTech expands Google Cloud & ServiceNow AI tie-up - [IT Brief Asia](#)
- Cresta Announces Partnership with New York Mets To Optimize Ticket Services With Conversational AI - [PR Newswire](#)
- Parloa survey finds over half of Americans actively avoid chatbots - NewsBytes
- AI agent testing, explained - [IBM](#)
- Genesys APAC partners honored as AI customer experience sees stronger demand - CRN Asia
- Human Oversight Becomes Central to Five9's New Voice AI Strategy at CCW - CX Today
- New Five9 Research: AI Adoption in CX Hits 92%, But Consumer Trust Still Depends on Human Support - Business Wire